disadvantaged, or the conquered. As a generalization, it can be said that terrorism is a means whose use derives from economic, social, national, or religious factors, either individually or in groups of more than one factor. The term *terrorism* has a negative and illegal connotation in the eyes of the general public and therefore, when countries (such as Iran, Syria, and North Korea) use terrorist methods or support terrorist organizations, they are defined as "state sponsors of terrorism" who are criticized by the free world, and against whom various measures can be taken.

The conclusion to be drawn from what has been said thus far is that the total elimination of the phenomenon of terror will apparently be possible only in a world in which the dichotomy between the strong and the weak does not exist. As an aside, it should be mentioned that global jihad emerged on the world stage only after the end of the Cold War and the era of the bipolar, bloc system. The global system in the Cold War era was much more stable than the situation of today, in which destabilization has created the conditions that have allowed terrorism to burst onto the scene.

The war against terror involves weighty moral questions, including whether what is permitted to the weak is also permitted to the strong. In a conventional war, there are international laws of war by which the actions of the two sides are gauged. In the struggle against terrorism (asymmetric or low-intensity warfare), no international laws have yet been made, and even the very definition of terrorism is still controversial. The enlightened world views the nuclear bombing of Hiroshima as a legal act of war. The enlightened world also sees the carpet-bombing of Dresden as a legal act of war. Would a similar bombing of Ramallah or Gaza by the Israeli air force be considered justified? Does the gap between the strong and the weak automatically invalidate the use of this means? Is the moral burden that lies upon the strong greater than the moral burden of the weak? Where is the moral line drawn with regard to measures that I—the strong— take to defend myself against the weak?

The international laws of war and agreed-upon international conventions were intended to establish moral and ethical norms determining what is permissible and what is forbidden to the two sides fighting a conventional war. Since to date there are no such laws regulating the war against terror, guerrilla warfare, and low-intensity wars, one cannot automatically expect and demand that the strong side adhere to and apply the regular laws of war while simultaneously forgiving the weaker side for